MIGRATION THEORIES AND PATTERNS (INDIA)

MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL → PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL → RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP → DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION → MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX → SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g8 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL

MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL · CHANGE IN USUAL RESIDENCE ACROSS A MEANINGFUL BOUNDARY · MOVEMENT INTO A COUNTRY OR RECEIVING REGION · MOVEMENT OUT OF A COUNTRY OR SENDING REGION · DATA RULE · PLACE OF BIRTH AND LAST USUAL RESIDENCE ANSWER DIFFERENT · MUST REMEMBER · MIGRATION ANALYSIS JOINS RAVENSTEIN'S REGULARITIES, LEE'S PUSH-PULL-INTERVENING-OBSTACLE FRAMEWORK, GRAVITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary	EMIGRATION → movement out of a country or sending region	MUST REMEMBER: Migration analysis joins Ravenstein's regularities, Lee's push-pull-intervening-obstacle framework, gravity and distance-decay, Zelinsky's mobility transition, Harris-Todaro
IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region	DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions	expected-income logic, network/cumulative causation and segmented labour demand to India's marriage, work, education, distress and circulation streams.

CORE CLAIM

- MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary
- IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region

MECHANISM

- EMIGRATION → movement out of a country or sending region
- DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Migration analysis joins Ravenstein's regularities, Lee's push-pull-intervening-obstacle framework, gravity and distance-decay, Zelinsky's mobility transition, Harris-Todaro
- expected-income logic, network/cumulative causation and segmented labour demand to India's marriage, work, education, distress and circulation streams.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions.

01

STAGE 01

PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL

PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL · ORIGIN PUSH · JOB LOSS, CONFLICT, DEBT, DISASTER, SOCIAL PRESSURE · DESTINATION PULL · WAGES, SAFETY, EDUCATION, AMENITIES, NETWORKS · INTERVENING OBSTACLES · DISTANCE, COST, BORDERS, INFORMATION GAPS · AGE, GENDER, CLASS AND SKILLS SHAPE WHO ACTUALLY MOVES

ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure

DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks → INTERVENING OBSTACLES → distance, cost, borders, information gaps → SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves

CORE CLAIM

- ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure
- DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks

MECHANISM

- INTERVENING OBSTACLES → distance, cost, borders, information gaps
- SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure
- DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves.

02

STAGE 02

RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP

RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP · MOST MOVES · SHORT DISTANCE RATHER THAN VERY LONG DISTANCE · STEP MIGRATION · VILLAGE TO TOWN TO CITY TO METROPOLIS · EACH MAJOR FLOW GENERATES SOME REVERSE MOVEMENT · USE AS AN ANALYTICAL GUIDE, NOT AS AN ABSOLUTE

MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance → STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis → COUNTER-STREAM → each major flow generates some reverse movement → LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

CORE CLAIM

- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

MECHANISM

- COUNTER-STREAM → each major flow generates some reverse movement
- LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule.

03

STAGE 03

DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION

DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION · DISTANCE RISES · COST, UNCERTAINTY AND SOCIAL RISK RISE · OPPORTUNITY NODES · NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT PART OF THE FLOW · REDUCE COST AND KEEP CORRIDORS ALIVE · MANY MIGRANTS MOVE IN STAGES RATHER THAN ONE LEAP

DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise → OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow → NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive → RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

CORE CLAIM

- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

MECHANISM

- NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive
- RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap.

04

STAGE 04

MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX

MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX · MARRIAGE, LOCAL FARM LABOUR, NEARBY RELOCATION · LABOUR, SERVICES, EDUCATION, CONSTRUCTION · PROFESSIONAL, BUSINESS AND HIGHER-EDUCATION MOBILITY · RETURN MIGRATION, RETIREMENT OR PERI-URBAN SPILLOVER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation	URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility	RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction	URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover	RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

CORE CLAIM

- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

MECHANISM

- URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility
- URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover.

05

STAGE 05

SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET · REDUCED PRESSURE, REMITTANCES, BUT LOSS OF YOUNG WORKERS · LABOUR GAIN, MARKET EXPANSION, BUT SERVICE PRESSURE · AGE-SEX EFFECT · SELECTIVE MIGRATION ALTERS BOTH ENDS DIFFERENTLY · MIGRATION REDISTRIBUTES BOTH OPPORTUNITY AND VULNERABILITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers	AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently	SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure	VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability	DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

MECHANISM

- AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently
- VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability.

06

STAGE 06

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT · ALL-INDIA RATE · 28.9% IN MOSPI MIGRATION IN INDIA 2020-21 · RURAL RATE · URBAN RATE · LABEL THE SOURCE-YEAR BEFORE USING ANY PERCENTAGE

RURAL RATE → 26.5%	URBAN RATE → 34.9%
INTRASTATE → 87.5%	INTERSTATE → 12.5%

CORE CLAIM

- ALL-INDIA RATE → 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
- RURAL RATE → 26.5%

MECHANISM

- URBAN RATE → 34.9%
- INTRASTATE → 87.5%

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INTERSTATE → 12.5%
- RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage.

07

STAGE 07

MARRIAGE MIGRATION DOMINANCE

MARRIAGE MIGRATION DOMINANCE · FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE · 86.8% IN MOSPI 2020-21 · ANALYTICAL RESULT · RAW MIGRATION TOTALS ARE NOT EQUAL TO LABOUR MIGRATION · RURAL-RURAL STREAM · REMAINS LARGE BECAUSE MARRIAGE MOBILITY IS LARGE · EXAM USE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21	RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large	FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration	EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly	ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

CORE CLAIM

- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

MECHANISM

- RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large
- EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration.

08

STAGE 08

INDIA CORRIDOR MAP

INDIA CORRIDOR MAP · SENDING BELTS · BIHAR, UTTAR PRADESH, ODISHA AND EAST-CENTRAL REGIONS · GAINER ZONES · MAHARASHTRA, GUJARAT, DELHI, HARYANA AND PUNJAB · CURRENT LOGIC · LABOUR MOVES TOWARD INDUSTRIAL, FARM AND SERVICE CORRIDORS · THE SAME CORRIDOR MAY MIX OPPORTUNITY AND DISTRESS MIGRATION

SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions

GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab → CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors → QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

CORE CLAIM

- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

MECHANISM

- CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors
- QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration.

09

STAGE 09

CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT

CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT · SEASONAL MOVEMENT · BRICK KILNS, HARVESTING, CONSTRUCTION, INFORMAL WORK · USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA · CAN MISS REPEATED SHORT-DURATION MOBILITY · POLICY EFFECT · PORTABILITY OF WELFARE BECOMES A MAJOR ISSUE · CITY EFFECT

SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work → USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility → POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue → CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Migrant stock differs from flow, lifetime from last-residence

CORE CLAIM

- SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
- USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility
- POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue

MECHANISM

- CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Migrant stock differs from flow, lifetime from last-residence
- migration, internal from international movement, seasonal/circular from permanent relocation, and

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Census reason-for-migration categories from causal explanation
- women recorded under marriage can also be workers, so one response category must not erase economic agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Census reason-for-migration categories from causal explanation; women recorded under marriage can also be workers, so one response category must not erase economic agency.

10

STAGE 10

LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC

LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC · DIVERSE JOB SET · BIG CITIES OFFER MULTIPLE LABOUR-MARKET ENTRY POINTS · EARLIER MIGRANTS LOWER COST AND RISK FOR LATER MIGRANTS · TRANSPORT + SERVICES · LARGE NODES COMPRESS SEARCH COSTS · SOME NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT FLOWS AS OPPORTUNITIES EXPAND · EVIDENCE LIMIT

DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points → NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants → TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs → COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand → EVIDENCE LIMIT: India patterns require Bihar-Uttar Pradesh source belts

CORE CLAIM

- DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points
- NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants
- TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs

MECHANISM

- COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: India patterns require Bihar-Uttar Pradesh source belts.
- Delhi–NCR/Mumbai/Surat/Bengaluru destinations, Kerala–Gulf corridors, tribal and drought-prone seasonal streams, remittances and care/skill loss

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of the review date, while surveys and administrative records are partial.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Delhi–NCR/Mumbai/Surat/Bengaluru destinations, Kerala–Gulf corridors, tribal and drought-prone seasonal streams, remittances and care/skill loss; Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of the review date, while surveys and administrative records are partial.

11

STAGE 11

MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE

MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE · RESIDENCE RULE, STREAM TYPE AND WHETHER MIGRATION IS INTERNAL · PUSH, PULL, OBSTACLES, DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION · MARRIAGE-HEAVY RURAL-RURAL AND LABOUR-HEAVY CORRIDOR MOVEMENTS IN INDIA · INTRASTATE DOMINANCE, REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND VERIFIED PYQ ROUTING

DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international → EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration → MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India → QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

MECHANISM

- MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India
- QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · TODAY THE BROAD LOGIC STILL SURVIVES IN UPDATED FORM · CONSTRUCTION, SERVICE AND METROPOLITAN CORRIDORS ATTRACT LABOUR FROM LOWER-INCOME · DELHI NCR, THE MUMBAI-PUNE BELT, GUJARAT'S INDUSTRIAL CORRIDOR, PUNJAB-HARYANA AND LOGISTICS ZONES, AND BENGALURU-LED SERVICE REGIONS REMAIN HIGH-ATTRACTION · MIGRATION IN INDIA IS THEREFORE BOTH DEVELOPMENT-SEEKING AND DISTRESS-DRIVEN · THE SAME CORRIDOR CAN CONTAIN BOTH ASPIRATION AND DISTRESS · ONE WORKER MAY MIGRATE FOR SKILL-LED MOBILITY, ANOTHER FOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: Today the broad logic still survives in updated form; industrial,
- construction, service and metropolitan corridors attract labour from lower-income agrarian regions.
- CAUTION: Delhi NCR, the Mumbai-Pune belt, Gujarat's industrial corridor, Punjab-Haryana farm
- and logistics zones, and Bengaluru-led service regions remain high-attraction spaces.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- CAUTION: Migration in India is therefore both development-seeking and distress-driven .
- CAUTION: The same corridor can contain both aspiration and distress: one worker may migrate for skill-led mobility, another for survival.
- CAUTION: Rural-urban migration is not automatically a sign of successful structural transformation if urban jobs remain informal and insecure.
- CAUTION: Pandemic-era reverse migration made seasonal and circular labour mobility far more visible in policy debate.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- MoSPI / NSS / PLFS-based report: latest official migration survey snapshot.
- Census of India: long-run migration concepts, place-of-birth and last-residence tables.
- CAUTION: For answer quality, always distinguish census concept, survey concept and temporary/circular movement.
- Most migrants in India are intrastate, not interstate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels